

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

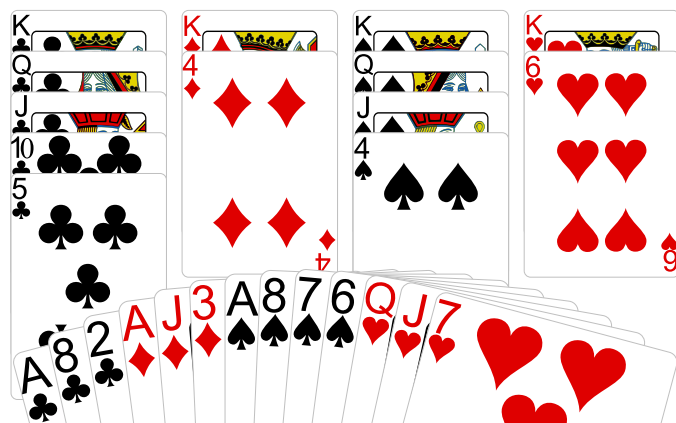
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

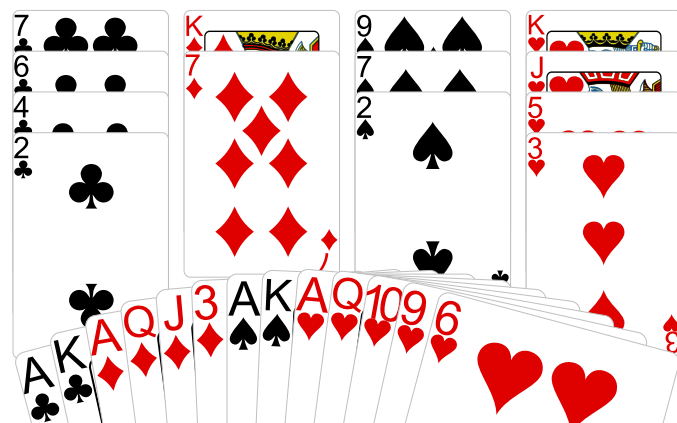
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



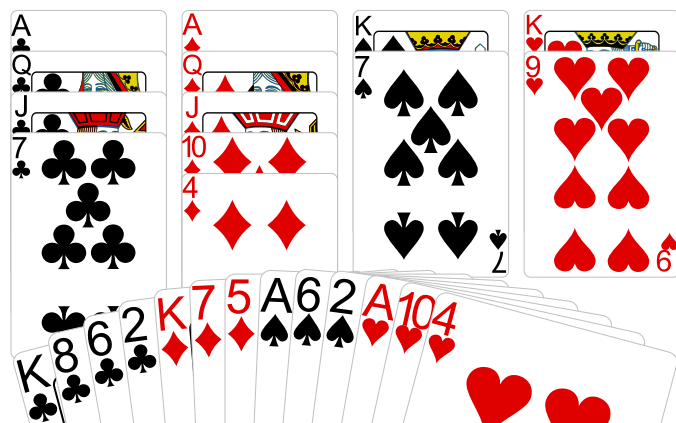
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



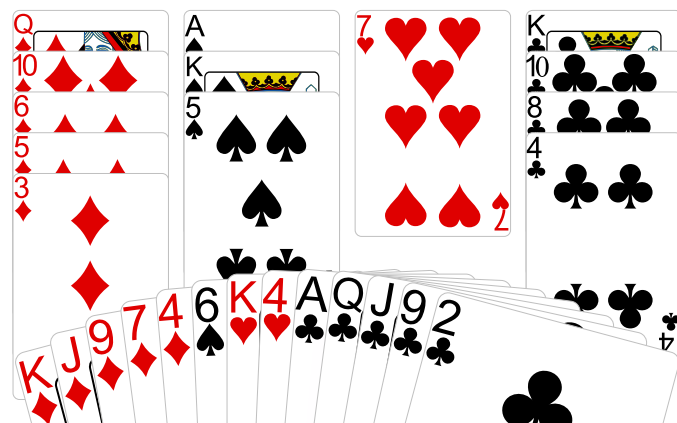
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 5♦ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 5♦
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 5 3
♥ A 5 4
♦ T 8 6 2
♣ 6 4

16
4 2
18

♠ A 8 7 6
♥ Q J 7
♦ A J 3
♣ A 8 2



♠ K Q J 4
♥ K 6
♦ K 4
♣ K Q J T 5

♠ 2
♥ T 9 8 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 5
♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

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When NORTH opens 1NT SOUTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT.

So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ K J 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ 7 6 4 2

2
7 27
4

♠ J 8 5

♥ 8 7 4

♦ T 8 6

♣ J T 5 3



♠ Q T 6 4 3

♥ 2

♦ 9 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 8

♠ A K

♥ A Q T 9 6

♦ A Q J 3

♣ A K

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West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	5NT	Pass
6♥	Pass	7NT	Pass

7NT by East

Deal 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 9 5 4 3
 ♥ Q J 8 7 6 5
 ♦ -
 ♣ 9 4

20
 3 3
 14

♠ K 7
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ A Q J T 4
 ♣ A Q J 7



♠ A 6 2
 ♥ A T 4
 ♦ K 7 5
 ♣ K 8 6 2

♠ Q J 8
 ♥ 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 6 3 2
 ♣ T 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			

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NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH

wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid

being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ K J 9 7 4
 ♣ A Q J 9 2

7
 14 12
 7

♠ Q J 8 4 3 2

♥ A 9 6 5 2

♦ 2

♣ 6



♠ T 9 7

♥ Q J T 8 3

♦ A 8

♣ 7 5 3

♠ A K 5

♥ 7

♦ Q T 6 5 3

♣ K T 8 4

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WEST thinks slam may be possible, so she
 uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for -
 keeping you out of slams when you are

missing two Aces!

West

1 ♦

4 ♣

4NT

All Pass

5 ♦ by West

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

3 ♦

4 ♠

5 ♦

South

Pass

Pass

Deal 5

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 8 6 2
♥ 4 2
♦ K Q J T
♣ Q 6 3

16
8 4
12

♠ K 4
♥ K Q T 9 5
♦ A 7 6
♣ A 5 4



♠ A Q J 7 3
♥ A J 8 6
♦ 5 3
♣ 8 7

♠ T 5
♥ 7 3
♦ 9 8 4 2
♣ K J T 9 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♥		.
All Pass			
6 ♥ by North			

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NORTH knows SOUTH has at least five ♠s,
and they might provide discards for two or
three

of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough,
SOUTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces NORTH knows there
are not enough points for Grand,

so she bids 6

♥

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